

Other sectors such as oil & gas, steel, energy and chemicals will also need CCUS for India to truly become carbon net-zero. A developing nation like India needs these very sectors to fire, in order to become a \$5-10-trillion (or a \$26-trillion, per EY's estimates) economy over the next few decades. "Our resource requirement will only go up till we reach the peak. So, most companies are focussing on reducing the intensity of CO₂ emissions," says Dhingra. "If you produce a tonne of cement and it emits 500 units of carbon, your trajectory will be to reduce that emission year-on-

go," says Rustagi. For a nation that imports over 85 per cent of its energy requirements every year but is rich in renewable energy sources, "the risk of climate change is indeed a huge opportunity", says Choudhary.

A PART FROM USHERING in billions of dollars of capital and solving complex problems innovatively, Indian start-ups have another claim to fame—the creation of a new kind of gig economy. In a nation with a nearly 500 million-strong but largely unskilled

er level, which is needed." NITI Aayog estimates India has 7.7 million gig workers, which it expects will swell to 23.5 million by 2029-30. A recent report by consulting firm BCG estimates India's gig workforce in the non-farm economy will balloon to 90 million over the long term.

Another significant impact they are expected to have is in India's transition to an organised market. Start-ups have managed the feat even in infrastructure-heavy capital-asset businesses such as buses and budget hotels. Karthik Reddy, Managing Partner of Blume Ventures, says it's



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J.B. SINGH

DIRECTOR, MOVIN EXPRESS

year through energy efficiency." Having that plan in place is critical.

The recently announced National Green Hydrogen Mission envisions India as one of the global hubs for making the alternate fuel. Says Minister for Petroleum and Natural Gas Hardeep Singh Puri: "What you are dealing with is not an idea whose time has come, but an idea that has already translated into a national project." But industrial plants typically operate for 30-40 years before they have to be phased out. Adopting alternative fuels will require substantial and expensive re-engineering of machines and processes. "A lot of capacity addition is yet to happen in India unlike in the US or Europe. It's an opportunity to design plants with a lower carbon footprint from the get

workforce, the rise of the likes of Ola, Zomato, bigbasket and other quick-commerce firms have brought forth this new category of formal workers. "Start-ups are creating a workforce that will be India's competitive edge in the future. How we leverage this workforce and what opportunities they can create for India 10-20 years from now, we don't have all the answers yet," says Matrix Partners' India MD, Rajinder Balaraman.

While studies show VC-funded start-ups play a huge role in GDP contribution right from day one, their contribution to employment comes a little later, says Ventureast Founder and Managing Partner Sarath Naru: "Beyond the first 5-10 years of their life, start-ups start creating a large number of jobs at a low-

because of their tech-first problem-solving approach: "They are not constrained by capex or legacy ways of thinking about business."

Their ripples will be felt across the country as new start-ups come from beyond the metros, such as Bihar's agritech start-up DeHaat, says Samir Sheth, Partner & Head-Deal Advisory Services, BDO India. "Talent and real estate costs are more competitive in these places and make the ventures cost-effective." Balaraman looks at this as redistribution of access. "Many of our investments are now focussing on the next 50-100 million digital consumers, too. That access creates opportunity, which creates wealth."

But before start-ups can take on the starring role being written for